# Tenant Records Cleanup

One messy tenant contact list, kept by three different people, turned into a clean, traceable list ready for rent-increase notices.

| CLIENT | ROLE | TOOLS | RECORDS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Larkspur Property Co. | Remote VA | Microsoft Excel | 44 rows, 3 buildings |

**44 → 39**
records after merging 5 duplicates

**34**
phone numbers standardized

**15**
issues flagged, not guessed

**0**
rows deleted from the original

## THE SCENARIO

Three staff members kept one shared tenant list. It had duplicate tenants, five phone formats, mixed date formats, missing emails and conflicting building names. Dana needs one reliable list before she sends rent-increase notices.

## THE TASK

Clean and standardize the list without losing or guessing any information. Anything that can't be confirmed goes back to the client as a clear question.

## WHAT'S INSIDE

Before and after: six sample rows p. 2

Cleanup Notes: every change, counted p. 3

After (Clean): the finished list p. 4

Needs Follow-up: questions for the client p. 6

Before (Original): the data as received p. 7

## WHAT IT SHOWS

- Judgment with client data: a wrong fix on a rent-increase list could send a notice to the wrong person, so uncertain values are flagged instead of guessed
- Traceability: Row IDs and a Merged From column show where every clean record came from
- Excel controls that keep the list clean: dropdown validation, a rent range check, conditional highlighting and frozen headers
- Client-ready communication: each open issue becomes a one-line question Dana can answer

## Before and after: six sample rows

Same records, before and after cleanup. R26 ("Ford, Natalie", Maple Terr) was a near-duplicate of R22 and was merged into it rather than deleted.

### BEFORE: AS RECEIVED

| Row ID | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Lease Start | Monthly Rent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R04 | Nguyen, Linh | Unit 103 | Cedar Court | 5125550103 | March 1 2024 | $1300 |
| R05 | tom bradley | 104 | cedar court | 512.555.0104 | 2023-11-01 | 1250 |
| R14 | HARRIS, DANIEL | 202 | Maple Ter. | (512)555-0202 | 12/01/2023 | $1,450 |
| R26 | Ford, Natalie | 209 | Maple Terr | 512.555.0209 | 09/01/2024 | 1500 |
| R31 | linda park | 302 | willow row | 5125550302 | 01/01/2024 | $1150 |
| R44 | Ava Morgan | Unit 313 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0313 | 2024-09-15 | 1175 |



### AFTER: STANDARDIZED AND FLAGGED

| Row ID | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Lease Start | Monthly Rent | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R04 | Linh Nguyen | 103 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0103 | 2024-03-01 | $1,300 | Needs follow-up |
| R05 | Tom Bradley | 104 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0104 | 2023-11-01 | $1,250 | Needs follow-up |
| R14 | Daniel Harris | 202 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0202 | 2023-12-01 | $1,450 | OK |
| R22 | Natalie Ford | 209 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0209 | 2024-09-01 | $1,500 | Needs follow-up |
| R31 | Linda Park | 302 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0302 | 2024-01-01 | $1,150 | OK |
| R44 | Ava Morgan | 313 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0313 | 2024-09-15 | $1,175 | OK |

Needs follow-up: kept in the list but held for the client's answer instead of guessed.

### WHAT CHANGED

- Names in one format: "HARRIS, DANIEL" became Daniel Harris
- Building names mapped to 3 official names: Maple Ter., MT, willow row
- Unit prefixes removed: "Unit 313" became 313
- Phones in one format: (512) 555-0000
- Dates as YYYY-MM-DD, rent stored as numbers

### WHAT DID NOT CHANGE

- Uncertain values: a bad email or short phone number is kept as entered and flagged
- The original data: the Before tab is untouched
- Traceability: every clean row keeps its original Row ID, and merged rows are listed in Merged From

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## Cleanup Notes tab

A summary of every change, with counts. In the workbook, the row totals are live formulas that update as follow-up items are resolved.

| Item | Count | Detail |
|---|---|---|
| Original rows | 44 | Untouched copy kept in 'Before (Original)' |
| Duplicates merged | 5 | Exact matches on name + unit + building; merged row IDs kept in 'Merged From'. Nothing deleted from Before tab. |
| Clean records | 39 | Should equal original rows minus duplicates merged |
| Names standardized | 8 | Title case, 'Last, First' flipped to 'First Last', extra spaces removed |
| Units standardized | 4 | Removed 'Unit' and '#' prefixes |
| Building names standardized | 9 | Abbreviations/case (CC, MT, WR, Maple Ter., etc.) mapped to 3 official names |
| Phone numbers standardized | 34 | All formatted (XXX) XXX-XXXX; incomplete numbers left as-is and flagged |
| Dates standardized | 14 | Mixed formats converted to YYYY-MM-DD |
| Rent values standardized | 8 | Removed $ and commas; stored as numbers formatted $#,##0 |
| Missing emails flagged | 5 | Not guessed; see Needs Follow-up |
| Questionable emails flagged | 3 | Typos kept as originally entered; suggested fix in Needs Follow-up |
| Records needing follow-up | 15 | Highlighted yellow in After tab |
| Open follow-up questions | 15 | One row per issue; some tenants have more than one |
| Formats & controls | | Header rows frozen on all tabs; dropdown validation on Building and Status; Rent must be 500–5000. |

## After (Clean) tab: 39 records

44 rows in, 39 out after merging 5 duplicates. Rows needing the client's input are highlighted. Building and Status use dropdown lists, and Rent only accepts values from 500 to 5,000.

| Row ID | Merged From | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Email | Lease Start | Monthly Rent | Notes | Status | Issue Summary |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R02 | R07 | Maria Gonzalez | 101 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0101 | maria.gonzalez@example.com | 2024-01-15 | $1,250 | | OK | |
| R03 | | James Carter | 102 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0102 | jcarter@example.net | 2024-03-01 | $1,300 | | OK | |
| R04 | | Linh Nguyen | 103 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0103 | | 2024-03-01 | $1,300 | | Needs follow-up | Missing email |
| R05 | | Tom Bradley | 104 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0104 | tom.bradley@example | 2023-11-01 | $1,250 | pays late sometimes | Needs follow-up | Invalid email (no domain ending, e.g. .com) |
| R06 | | Aisha Rahman | 105 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0105 | aisha.r@example.org | 2024-06-01 | $1,275 | | OK | |
| R08 | | Derek Owens | 106 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0106 | derek.owens@example.com | 2024-07-15 | $1,300 | | OK | |
| R09 | | Priya Shah | 107 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0107 | priya.shah@exmaple.com | 2024-08-01 | $1,325 | | Needs follow-up | Possible typo in domain ('exmaple') |
| R10 | | Robert Kim | 108 | Cedar Court | 512-555-010 | rkim@example.net | 2024-02-01 | $1,250 | | Needs follow-up | Phone has too few digits; original kept |
| R11 | | Elena Petrova | 109 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0109 | | 2023-09-15 | $1,200 | | Needs follow-up | Missing email |
| R12 | | Marcus Hill | 110 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0110 | marcus.hill@example.com | 2024-05-01 | | | Needs follow-up | Missing current rent |
| R13 | R17 | Grace Liu | 201 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0201 | grace.liu@example.com | 2024-01-01 | $1,450 | | OK | |
| R14 | | Daniel Harris | 202 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0202 | dharris@example.org | 2023-12-01 | $1,450 | | OK | |
| R15 | | Sofia Martinez | 203 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0203 | sofia.martinez@example.com | 2024-04-15 | $1,475 | | OK | |
| R16 | | Kevin O'Brien | 204 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0204 | kevin.obrien@example.com | 2025-03-04 | $1,450 | | Needs follow-up | Read as MM/DD (March 4); only lease not on the 1st or 15th |
| R18 | | Hannah Brooks | 205 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0205 | | 2024-06-01 | $1,500 | | Needs follow-up | Missing email |
| R19 | | Omar Haddad | 206 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0206 | omar.haddad@example.net | 2024-07-01 | $1,450 | | OK | |
| R20 | | Chloe Bennett | 207 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0207 | chloe.bennett@example.com | 2024-08-15 | $1,475 | | OK | |
| R21 | | Luis Ramirez | 208 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0208 | luis.ramirez@example..com | 2023-10-01 | $1,425 | | Needs follow-up | Invalid email (double dot) |
| R22 | R26 | Natalie Ford | 209 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0209 | natalie.ford@example.com | 2024-09-01 | $1,500 | moved out Aug - new tenant? | Needs follow-up | Note says tenant may have moved out |
| R23 | | Ben Turner | 210 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0210 | ben.turner@example.com | 2024-02-15 | $1,450 | | OK | |

# After (Clean) tab (continued)

Rows 21–39 of 39

| Row ID | Merged From | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Email | Lease Start | Monthly Rent | Notes | Status | Issue Summary |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R24 | | Ivy Chen | 211 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0211 | ivy.chen@example.org | 2023-11-01 | $1,450 | | OK | |
| R25 | | Samuel Adeyemi | 212 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0212 | | 2024-03-15 | $1,475 | | Needs follow-up | Missing email |
| R27 | | Rachel Stone | 213 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0213 | rachel.stone@example.com | 2024-05-15 | $1,500 | | OK | |
| R28 | | Jason Lee | 214 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0214 | jason.lee@example.com | 2024-06-15 | $1,450 | | OK | |
| R29 | | Mia Patel | 215 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0215 | mia.patel@example.com | 2024-07-01 | $1,475 | | OK | |
| R30 | R36 | Anthony Russo | 301 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0301 | anthony.russo@example.com | 2024-01-15 | $1,150 | | OK | |
| R31 | | Linda Park | 302 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0302 | linda.park@example.net | 2024-01-01 | $1,150 | | OK | |
| R32 | | Carlos Vega | 303 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0303 | carlos.vega@example.com | 2023-12-15 | $1,175 | | OK | |
| R33 | | Emily Watson | 304 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0304 | emily.watson@example.com | 2024-04-01 | $1,150 | | Needs follow-up | Unit shared with Tyler Grant (R34) |
| R34 | | Tyler Grant | 304 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0333 | tyler.grant@example.com | 2024-10-01 | $1,150 | | Needs follow-up | Unit shared with Emily Watson (R33) |
| R35 | | Fatima Noor | 305 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0305 | fatima.noor@example.org | 2024-05-01 | $1,200 | | OK | |
| R37 | | Jacob Miller | 306 | Willow Row | 512-555-03 | jacob.miller@example.com | 2024-06-01 | $1,175 | | Needs follow-up | Phone has too few digits; original kept |
| R38 | | Olivia Scott | 307 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0307 | olivia.scott@example.com | 2024-07-15 | $1,200 | | OK | |
| R39 | | Ethan Brown | 308 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0308 | | 2024-08-01 | $1,150 | | Needs follow-up | Missing email |
| R40 | R45 | Zoe Adams | 309 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0309 | zoe.adams@example.com | 2024-02-01 | $1,175 | | OK | |
| R41 | | Noah Clark | 310 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0310 | noah.clark@example.com | 2023-09-01 | $1,150 | | OK | |
| R42 | | Isabella Wright | 311 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0311 | isabella.wright@example.com | 2024-03-01 | $1,200 | | OK | |
| R43 | | Liam Foster | 312 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0312 | liam.foster@example.com | 2024-05-01 | $1,150 | | OK | |
| R44 | | Ava Morgan | 313 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0313 | ava.morgan@example.com | 2024-09-15 | $1,175 | | OK | |

# Needs Follow-up tab: 15 questions for the client

One row per issue, each with a direct question Dana can answer in a few words. Her answers go in the last column.

| Row ID | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Field | Current Value | Issue | Question for Dana | Dana's Answer |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R04 | Linh Nguyen | 103 | Cedar Court | Email | (blank) | Missing email | What is this tenant's email, or should the notice go by mail/hand delivery? | |
| R05 | Tom Bradley | 104 | Cedar Court | Email | tom.bradley@example | Invalid email (no domain ending, e.g. .com) | What is the full email address? Ending is missing. | |
| R09 | Priya Shah | 107 | Cedar Court | Email | priya.shah@exmaple.com | Possible typo in domain ('exmaple') | Confirm: is it priya.shah@example.com? | |
| R10 | Robert Kim | 108 | Cedar Court | Phone | 512-555-010 | Phone has too few digits; original kept | What is the full phone number? | |
| R11 | Elena Petrova | 109 | Cedar Court | Email | (blank) | Missing email | What is this tenant's email, or should the notice go by mail/hand delivery? | |
| R12 | Marcus Hill | 110 | Cedar Court | Monthly Rent | (blank) | Missing current rent | What is the current rent? Needed to calculate the increase. | |
| R16 | Kevin O'Brien | 204 | Maple Terrace | Lease Start | 2025-03-04 | Read as MM/DD (March 4); only lease not on the 1st or 15th | Is the lease start March 4, 2025 or April 3, 2025? | |
| R18 | Hannah Brooks | 205 | Maple Terrace | Email | (blank) | Missing email | What is this tenant's email, or should the notice go by mail/hand delivery? | |
| R21 | Luis Ramirez | 208 | Maple Terrace | Email | luis.ramirez@example..com | Invalid email (double dot) | Confirm: is it luis.ramirez@example.com? | |
| R22 | Natalie Ford | 209 | Maple Terrace | Notes | moved out Aug - new tenant? | Note says tenant may have moved out | Is Natalie Ford still in 209? If not, who is the current tenant? | |
| R25 | Samuel Adeyemi | 212 | Maple Terrace | Email | (blank) | Missing email | What is this tenant's email, or should the notice go by mail/hand delivery? | |
| R33 | Emily Watson | 304 | Willow Row | Unit | 304 | Unit shared with Tyler Grant (R34) | Are both current tenants (roommates), or did one replace the other? | |
| R34 | Tyler Grant | 304 | Willow Row | Unit | 304 | Unit shared with Emily Watson (R33) | Are both current tenants (roommates), or did one replace the other? | |
| R37 | Jacob Miller | 306 | Willow Row | Phone | 512-555-03 | Phone has too few digits; original kept | What is the full phone number? | |
| R39 | Ethan Brown | 308 | Willow Row | Email | (blank) | Missing email | What is this tenant's email, or should the notice go by mail/hand delivery? | |

# Before (Original) tab: 44 rows as received

The untouched source data, with a Row ID column added so every change can be traced back.

| Row ID | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Email | Lease Start | Monthly Rent | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R02 | Maria Gonzalez | 101 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0101 | maria.gonzalez@example.com | 01/15/2024 | $1,250 | |
| R03 | JAMES CARTER | 102 | Cedar Ct | 512-555-0102 | jcarter@example.net | 2024-03-01 | 1300 | |
| R04 | Nguyen, Linh | Unit 103 | Cedar Court | 5125550103 | | March 1 2024 | $1300 | |
| R05 | tom bradley | 104 | cedar court | 512.555.0104 | tom.bradley@example | 2023-11-01 | 1250 | pays late sometimes |
| R06 | Aisha Rahman | 105 | Cedar Court | +1 512 555 0105 | aisha.r@example.org | 06/01/2024 | 1,275 | |
| R07 | Maria Gonzalez | 101 | Cedar Court | 512-555-0101 | maria.gonzalez@example.com | 1/15/2024 | 1250 | |
| R08 | Derek Owens | 106 | CC | (512) 555-0106 | derek.owens@example.com | 2024-07-15 | $1,300 | |
| R09 | Priya Shah | 107 | Cedar Court | 512-555-0107 | priya.shah@exmaple.com | 08/01/2024 | 1325 | |
| R10 | Robert Kim | 108 | Cedar Court | 512-555-010 | rkim@example.net | 2024-02-01 | 1250 | |
| R11 | Elena Petrova | #109 | Cedar Court | (512) 555-0109 | | 09/15/2023 | 1200 | |
| R12 | Marcus Hill | 110 | Cedar Court | 512 555 0110 | marcus.hill@example.com | 2024-05-01 | | |
| R13 | Grace Liu | 201 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0201 | grace.liu@example.com | 2024-01-01 | 1450 | |
| R14 | HARRIS, DANIEL | 202 | Maple Ter. | (512)555-0202 | dharris@example.org | 12/01/2023 | $1,450 | |
| R15 | Sofia Martinez | 203 | Maple Terrace | 5125550203 | sofia.martinez@example.com | 2024-04-15 | 1475 | |
| R16 | Kevin O'Brien | 204 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0204 | kevin.obrien@example.com | 03/04/2025 | 1450 | |
| R17 | Grace Liu | 201 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0201 | grace.liu@example.com | 2024-01-01 | 1450 | |
| R18 | Hannah Brooks | 205 | maple terrace | 512.555.0205 | | 2024-06-01 | 1500 | |
| R19 | Omar Haddad | Unit 206 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0206 | omar.haddad@example.net | 07/01/2024 | 1450 | |
| R20 | Chloe Bennett | 207 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0207 | chloe.bennett@example.com | 2024-08-15 | 1475 | |
| R21 | Luis Ramirez | 208 | MT | 512-555-0208 | luis.ramirez@example..com | 2023-10-01 | 1425 | |
| R22 | Natalie Ford | 209 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0209 | natalie.ford@example.com | 2024-09-01 | 1500 | moved out Aug - new tenant? |
| R23 | Ben Turner | 210 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0210 | ben.turner@example.com | 2024-02-15 | 1,450 | |

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# Before (Original) tab (continued)

Rows 23–44 of 44

| Row ID | Tenant Name | Unit | Building | Phone | Email | Lease Start | Monthly Rent | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R24 | Ivy Chen | 211 | Maple Terrace | (512) 555-0211 | ivy.chen@example.org | 11/01/2023 | 1450 | |
| R25 | Samuel Adeyemi | 212 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0212 | | 2024-03-15 | 1475 | |
| R26 | Ford, Natalie | 209 | Maple Terr | 512.555.0209 | natalie.ford@example.com | 09/01/2024 | 1500 | |
| R27 | Rachel Stone | 213 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0213 | rachel.stone@example.com | 2024-05-15 | 1500 | |
| R28 | Jason Lee | 214 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0214 | jason.lee@example.com | 2024-06-15 | 1450 | |
| R29 | Mia Patel | 215 | Maple Terrace | 512-555-0215 | mia.patel@example.com | 2024-07-01 | 1475 | |
| R30 | Anthony Russo | 301 | Willow Row | 512-555-0301 | anthony.russo@example.com | 2024-01-15 | 1150 | |
| R31 | linda park | 302 | willow row | 5125550302 | linda.park@example.net | 01/01/2024 | $1150 | |
| R32 | Carlos Vega | 303 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0303 | carlos.vega@example.com | 2023-12-15 | 1175 | |
| R33 | Emily Watson | 304 | WR | 512-555-0304 | emily.watson@example.com | 2024-04-01 | 1150 | |
| R34 | Tyler Grant | 304 | Willow Row | 512-555-0333 | tyler.grant@example.com | 2024-10-01 | 1150 | |
| R35 | Fatima Noor | 305 | Willow Row | 512-555-0305 | fatima.noor@example.org | 05/01/2024 | 1200 | |
| R36 | Anthony Russo | 301 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0301 | anthony.russo@example.com | 01/15/2024 | $1,150 | |
| R37 | Jacob Miller | 306 | Willow Row | 512-555-03 | jacob.miller@example.com | 2024-06-01 | 1175 | |
| R38 | Olivia Scott | 307 | Willow Row | 512-555-0307 | olivia.scott@example.com | 2024-07-15 | 1200 | |
| R39 | Ethan Brown | 308 | Willow Row | 512-555-0308 | | 2024-08-01 | 1150 | |
| R40 | Zoe Adams | 309 | Willow Row | 512-555-0309 | zoe.adams@example.com | 2024-02-01 | 1175 | |
| R41 | Noah Clark | 310 | Willow Row | 512-555-0310 | noah.clark@example.com | 2023-09-01 | 1150 | |
| R42 | WRIGHT, Isabella | 311 | Willow Row | 512-555-0311 | isabella.wright@example.com | 2024-03-01 | 1200 | |
| R43 | Liam Foster | 312 | Willow Row | 512-555-0312 | liam.foster@example.com | 2024-05-01 | 1150 | |
| R44 | Ava Morgan | Unit 313 | Willow Row | (512) 555-0313 | ava.morgan@example.com | 2024-09-15 | 1175 | |
| R45 | Zoe Adams | 309 | Willow Row | 512-555-0309 | zoe.adams@example.com | 2024-02-01 | 1175 | |